

Bronte BIA Partnership Meeting - Minutes

Date: Tuesday, February 19, 2026

Time: 2:00 PM

Location: Peach Coffee Shop, Bronte

Attendees

- **Greg Kowalczyk** - Race Co-Director, Bronte Harbour Classic 5K
- **Kylie Wilson** - Executive Director, Bronte BIA

Regrets: Charles (Race Co-Director) - unable to attend

1. Event Background & Organizing Team

Organizing Team Credentials

- Event in development for 3-4 years
- Bronte Runners group: 9 core community organizers
- Leadership includes Olympic-level coaching expertise
- Partnership with Greg Pace (organizer of Moon in June race, 35-year track record)

Demonstrated Community Impact

- **Terry Fox Run 2025:** Organizing team raised **\$27,000** (largest Oakville fundraising group)
- Consistent year-over-year growth in community fundraising (from \$1,000 to \$27,000 over 4 years)
- Regular participation: 40-50 member cohort with established infrastructure

2. Event Status Update

Current Registration & Sponsorships

- **Current registrations:** ~90 participants (4 months before event)
- **Registration goal:** 800 participants
- **Progress:** 11.25% of goal achieved
- **Timeline:** 4 months remaining; historically, most race signups occur 6-8 weeks before event

Confirmed Sponsors

- **CIBC** - Founding Sponsor (confirmed)
- **On (shoe manufacturer)** - Sponsoring 12 pairs of professional running shoes for elite runners

Sponsor Needs

- **Title Sponsor** - Still seeking (opportunity to have name featured prominently)

3. Event Details Confirmed

Date & Time

- **Date:** Father's Day - Sunday, June 21, 2026
- **Event hours:** 7:00 AM - 3:00 PM
- **Race start:** 8:00 AM
- **Street closure:** 7:00 AM
- **Vendor setup:** 5:00 AM

Race Components

5K Adult Race:

- Scenic waterfront course
- First year event (future expansion to 10K planned)
- 10K route would extend to Appleby College area (Rebecca, Fourth Line loop)
- Elite runner prizes and competition

Kids 1K Fun Run:

- Loop within park grounds
- Ages 2-12
- Family-focused Father's Day activity

All-Day Festival (Open to Public)

Key Differentiator: Extended dwell time model - unlike typical race formats where participants leave immediately post-event, BHC 5K creates all-day destination experience

Festival Components:

- Vendor expo (30-50 booths - see Section 4)
- Live music programming
- Family activities (mascots, face painting, jumping castles)
- Awards ceremony with professional MC
- Open to general public (not limited to race participants)

Economic Impact Strategy:

Drive extended visitor time in Bronte business district throughout day (7 AM - 3 PM), creating multiple purchase opportunities (breakfast, lunch, coffee, retail, services)

4. Vendor Expo Planning

Target Vendor Count

- **Planned:** 30-50 vendor booths
- **Capacity:** Can accommodate up to 70 if demand exists
- **Current assessment:** Laying out space to optimize vendor placement

Vendor Details

- **Cost:** \$250 per 10x10 booth
- **Duration:** 7-hour event (some vendors prefer full weekend events)
- **Setup:** 5:00 AM arrival for vendors
- **Location:** Throughout park, centered around gazebo area
- **Vendor types sought:** Not limited to sports/fitness
 - Community businesses
 - Kids toys and activities
 - Accessories and gifting
 - Shopping experiences
 - Food vendors

Vendor Layout Strategy

- Start/finish line ~100 meters apart (for exact race distance measurement)
- Finish line at gazebo entrance
- Gazebo serves as main hub
- Vendors spread throughout park
- Planters at finish line (potential sponsor activation)

5. BIA Partnership Commitments

Marketing & Communications

BIA Newsletter:

- Bi-weekly community newsletter
- **Subscriber base:** Just under 4,000 people
- **Action:** Beginning of March, feature BHC 5K as lead story
- **Coverage:** Event details, how businesses can get involved (sponsors, vendors, participants)

Member Business Communication:

- BIA cannot share member contact information directly
- **Action:** BIA will distribute event opportunity to member businesses
- **Note:** Member engagement historically low (even major events like Canada Day struggle with business participation)

Website & Social Media:

- Monthly happenings calendar listing
- Social media promotion across BIA channels
- Event posters and promotional materials

Community Bulletin Board:

- **Location:** Gazebo at Bronte Heritage Waterfront Park (BIA-operated)
- **Action:** BIA will post event information
- Event posters welcome

6. Business & Vendor Connections Recommended

Fitness Organizations (4 in Bronte)

BIA recommended approaching these complementary (non-competing) fitness businesses:

1. **Hub Fitness**
2. **Live Well Fitness** - Monitored fitness experience
3. **Executive** - Private classes (across from Peach Coffee)
4. **Pinnacle Pilates**

Opportunity: Swag bag materials, flyers, promotional items for 800+ runner bags

Coffee Shops

- **Peach Coffee** - Already connected (serves as runner group base on weekends)
- **Rust**
- **Catch**

Note: Coffee shops typically say yes to community initiatives

Restaurants

- **Boathouse** - Will be open Father's Day
- **Duffy's** - Will be open Father's Day
- **Goal:** Create vibrant race day atmosphere in Bronte

Farmer's Market Vendors

- **Civitan Farmer's Market**
- **~70 vendors** currently signed up for 2026 season

- **Action:** BIA will share event opportunity with farmer's market vendors
- **Rationale:** Market vendors specialize in pop-up experiences and are ideal fit for vendor expo
- **BIA farmer's market booth cost:** \$25/day (for comparison to race \$250 booth)

Bronte Legion

- **Opportunity:** Often hosts pop-up markets
- **Action:** Approach Legion for vendor lists and connections
- **Potential:** Legion may have vendor contacts BIA doesn't

7. PRIORITY SPONSOR RECOMMENDATION: Cedar Planters

BIA's Top Title Sponsor Candidate

Company Profile

- **Location:** Great Lakes Boulevard, Bronte
- **Business:** Cedar planters and garden products
- **Growth Status:** Canada's fastest-growing company (recent national media coverage)
- **Ownership:** Local Bronte residents
- **BIA Track Record:** Fall 2025 event sponsor (high-quality activation, strong ROI)

Strategic Fit Analysis

- **Local ownership & community commitment** - Bronte-based founders
- **High-growth trajectory** - National visibility and expansion
- **Proven sponsor performance** - Exceeded BIA expectations at previous event
- **Product-event alignment** - Peak gardening season (June), outdoor/health values
- **Premium presentation standards** - Professional booth and activation quality

Potential Activation Opportunities

Title Sponsorship:

- "Cedar Planters Bronte Harbour Classic" branding
- Premium logo placement across all channels

Finish Line Activation:

- Product placement at finish line (high photo/social media visibility)
- Aesthetic enhancement of event environment

Vendor Expo:

- Prime booth location for product sales and demonstration
- Direct access to 800+ target demographic households

Next Steps

- Greg to initiate title sponsor discussion with Cedar Planters ownership
- Emphasize June timing, Father's Day demographic, finish line opportunity

8. Music & Entertainment

BIA Musician Resources

- BIA maintains curated list of local musicians for community events
- Can provide musician names, contacts, and pricing

Budget Parameters

- **Premium Acts:** \$2,000+
- **Local Musicians:** \$400 range (aligned with event budget)
- **BIA Recommendation:** Gigi (local performer with strong BIA event track record)

Event Entertainment Strategy

Target Atmosphere:

- Family-friendly, multigenerational appeal
- Interactive/danceable format proven successful at BIA Thursday concerts
- Community-focused over high-production value

Action Items:

- Kylie to provide musician contact list and pricing
- Evaluate Gigi booking
- Sound of Music festival partnership opportunity (exploratory, status uncertain)
- Backup options from Moon in June race contacts

9. Media Contacts & PR Strategy

BIA-Provided Media Contacts (Actively Seeking Content):

Local News Outlets

1. **Lucas and Tyler** - Oakville News
1. **Davidson** - Inside Halton / The Beaver
1. **TV Halton**

Recommended Story Angles

Economic Impact:

- New annual event driving Father's Day tourism to Bronte business district
- 800+ participants + families = significant retail/restaurant traffic
- Vendor expo creating SMB exposure opportunity (30-50 businesses)

Community Development:

- Inaugural Father's Day tradition establishment
- Local organizers (Bronte Runners) creating hometown legacy event
- Oakville Dads Charity beneficiary

Credibility Indicators:

- CIBC founding sponsor
- Organizing team track record (\$27,000 Terry Fox fundraising - largest Oakville group)
- Town of Oakville official support and permitting

Action Items:

- Kylie to provide full media contact information
- Greg to develop press materials and story pitches

10. Route Planning & Logistics Update

Potential Route Change

Issue Identified:

- Anna Rookyard (Town of Oakville) informed Greg of construction in Coronation Park
- **Location:** East parking lot
- **Timing:** Scheduled during race time (June 21)

Impact on Route:

- Original plan: Straight through Coronation Park
- May need to route around construction area ("around the building, the shores")
- Still accessing Coronation Park, just modified path

Current Route Strategy

Clockwise Start:

- Race starts at 8:00 AM heading clockwise
- Runners return opposite direction
- **Benefit:** Street reopens immediately after start wave passes
- Minimizes closure duration and impact

Geographic Points:

- Marine Drive → Coronation Park → Return via different streets
- Original plan: Marine Drive → Jones → Lakefront
- Now: May need to loop around Lakeshore construction area

Future Route (10K Expansion)

- Extend to Appleby College area
- Route through Rebecca and Fourth Line
- Return to Bronte
- **Requirement:** Nearly complete Lakeshore closure
- **Timeline:** Once 5K concept proven and established

11. Additional BIA Insights

Business Outreach Strategy

BIA approach to member engagement:

- Business participation requires multiple touchpoints and consistent promotion
- BIA will actively promote event to member businesses through established channels
- Recommended casting wide net beyond Bronte (farmer's market, Legion, regional vendors)
- Position as "ground floor opportunity" for founding partners of new annual tradition

Political & Community Leadership Engagement

Strategic Context:

- 2026 municipal election year (heightened councillor visibility)
- Recent mayoral candidate announcement
- Event already has councillor support (secured Father's Day date through 2-month Town negotiation)

Dignitary Participation Strategy:

- Invite elected officials for speaking opportunities (race start, awards ceremony)
- Leverage political visibility to amplify event profile
- Election year timing increases likelihood of participation and media coverage

13. Swag Bags & Business Opportunities

Swag Bag Program

Event offering:

- Every runner receives swag bag (800+ bags)
- Opportunity for businesses to include samples, flyers, promotional items
- Direct reach to active, affluent families

Target businesses:

- Fitness centers (4 Bronte locations)
- Coffee shops
- Restaurants
- Family services
- Health and wellness
- Local retailers

Cost: Not explicitly discussed, but typically \$250 for swag bag inclusion

Action Item: Greg to provide swag bag details and pricing to BIA for member distribution

14. Vendor & Operational Details

Street Closure Timeline

- **7:00 AM:** Street closure begins
- **5:00 AM:** Vendor setup and arrival
- **8:00 AM:** Race start
- **9:30 AM:** (approx.) Last finishers, street reopens
- **3:00 PM:** Event concludes

Vendor Experience Level

Greg's note:

- Vendors accustomed to early setup (farmer's markets, festivals)
- 5 AM arrival not considered problematic for experienced vendors
- 7-hour event duration may deter some vendors (prefer full weekend)

Pricing Context

- **BHC 5K vendor booth:** \$250
- **BIA farmer's market booth:** \$25/day
- **Bronte Legion booth:** Similar to BIA pricing (~\$25/day)

Kylie's concern: Unknown if farmer's market vendors will pay \$250 vs. their usual \$25

Strategy: Promote value (800+ attendees, all-day exposure, Father's Day shopping traffic)

15. BIA Actions & Commitments Summary

Immediate Actions (By End of February)

- [] Send local musician names and pricing to Greg
- [] Send media contact information (Lucas, Tyler, Davidson, TV Halton)
- [] Prepare for beginning of March newsletter feature

March Actions

- [] **Beginning of March:** Feature BHC 5K as lead story in BIA newsletter (~4,000 subscribers)
- [] Distribute event opportunity to BIA member businesses
- [] Share vendor expo opportunity with Civitan Farmer's Market vendors
- [] Post event information on BIA website monthly happenings
- [] Post event posters on gazebo community bulletin board
- [] Social media promotion begins

Ongoing Support (March - June)

- [] Continue social media promotion
- [] Promote business participation (sponsors, vendors, runners)
- [] Coordinate with Greg on promotional materials and timing

Personal Commitment

- [] Kylie to sign up her family for race ("We've got nothing going on")

16. Event Team Actions & Next Steps

Materials to Provide to BIA

- [] Event story/details for newsletter feature (beginning of March deadline)
- [] High-resolution promotional graphics and logos
- [] Event posters for bulletin board and business distribution
- [] Swag bag opportunity details and pricing
- [] Vendor expo details and application
- [] Sponsorship package for member business distribution

Sponsor Follow-Up

- [] **Priority:** Approach Cedar Planters for title sponsorship
- Contact on Great Lakes Boulevard
- Highlight finish line activation opportunity
- Emphasize June timing (peak gardening season)
- Reference BIA partnership success

Vendor Recruitment

- [] Follow up with Civitan Farmer's Market (after BIA introduction)

- [] Approach Bronte Legion for vendor connections
- [] Connect with 4 Bronte fitness organizations (swag bags and/or vendor booths)
- [] Approach Rust and Catch coffee shops
- [] Approach Boathouse and Duffy's restaurants

Music & Entertainment

- [] Review BIA musician list when received
- [] Consider booking Gigi (BIA recommendation)
- [] Finalize \$400 budget local musician vs. Burlington contacts

Media Outreach

- [] Contact Lucas and Tyler (Oakville News)
- [] Contact Davidson (Inside Halton/Beaver)
- [] Contact TV Halton
- [] Prepare story angles and press materials

Route Coordination

- [] Follow up with Anna Rookyard on Coronation Park construction status
- [] Finalize modified route if construction confirmed
- [] Update route maps and promotional materials

16. Meeting Outcomes & Strategic Summary

Partnership Confirmed ■

BIA Commitment Secured:

- Multi-channel promotional support (newsletter to 4,000 subscribers, website, social media, bulletin board)
- Business community connector (member outreach, farmer's market vendor network)
- Media relationship facilitation (direct contacts provided)
- Local musician resources and recommendations

High-Priority Opportunities Identified

1. **Cedar Planters** - Title sponsor candidate (fastest-growing company in Canada, local ownership, proven BIA sponsor)
1. **Civitan Farmer's Market** - 70 vendor pipeline for expo participation
1. **Bronte Legion** - Supplementary vendor network access

1. **4 Fitness Organizations** - Swag bag and sponsorship targets (Hub, Live Well, Executive, Pinnacle Pilates)

1. **Local Musicians** - \$400 budget tier, BIA-vetted performers

1. **Media Outlets** - Active content needs (Oakville News, Inside Halton, TV Halton)

Risk Factors & Mitigation

- **Vendor pricing gap** (\$250 event vs. \$25 farmer's market): Mitigate through value positioning (800+ attendees, Father's Day traffic, all-day exposure)

- **Route modification** (Coronation Park construction): Contingency planning in progress with Town coordination

- **Business engagement levels**: Realistic expectations set; casting wide net beyond Bronte

Success Indicators

- Strong founding sponsor base (CIBC, On shoes)
- Proven organizing team (\$27,000 fundraising track record)
- Clear event differentiation (extended dwell time model vs. traditional race format)
- 4-month promotional runway with BIA partnership secured
- BIA Executive Director personally committed to event success

17. Next Meeting / Check-In

Not formally scheduled

Suggested follow-up:

- Early March: Check in after BIA newsletter feature
- Mid-April: Registration milestone update (target: 200-300 registered)
- Mid-May: Final coordination (2 weeks before event)

Communication:

- Email for ongoing coordination
- Greg to provide materials as outlined
- Kylie to send musician and media contacts

Minutes Prepared By: Greg Kowalczyk

Date Prepared: February 19, 2026

Distribution: Charles (Co-Director), Kylie Wilson (BIA), Event Planning Team